
Imagine
what we can
become



The MIT Media Lab

Imagine what we can become

Every day, we imagine, design, and invent a future in which **everyone** has the opportunity to flourish. This philosophy is at the heart of the MIT Media Lab. With more than 25 research groups, we explore technologies ranging from artificial intelligence to bioengineered materials, tackling challenges from the ocean's depths to the farthest reaches of space. **Together, we are pushing the limits of innovation and shaping a future that is both equitable and sustainable.**

A world without boundaries

Forty years ago, the Media Lab was founded on a revolutionary idea: breakthroughs happen when disciplines converge. We embrace an interdisciplinary approach to tackle challenges as diverse as artificial intelligence, robotics, sustainable urban systems, and wearable technologies. Our work spans scales and frontiers – exploring the depths of the ocean, unlocking the mysteries of the human brain, and pushing the boundaries of space exploration. **By dissolving traditional silos, we don't just create new technologies; we imagine how those technologies can transform lives and inspire a future where creativity drives opportunity for all.**





Mission + Vision

Our guiding principles

Our mission defines what we do and why:

To create transformative technologies, experiences, and systems that enable people to reimagine and redesign their lives.

We engage people everywhere in meaningful, creative experiences integrating art, science, engineering, and design. Experimenting in the spaces where humanity and technology interface, we work with organizations and communities around the world to transform people's dreams and ideas into reality through excellence in education, research, innovation, and inspiring creativity.

Our vision is bold and inclusive:

To invent a better and more just future—by, with, and for all.

Our community of students, researchers, faculty, and staff transforms ideas into impactful new applications, fields, and movements by exploring imaginatively, experimenting iteratively, collaborating playfully, and analyzing critically. We create opportunities for people everywhere to envision and build better lives, communities, and environments.

A community of innovators

The Media Lab is powered by its people – a vibrant, diverse, and deeply collaborative community. At its core are 25+ visionary faculty members, leaders in their fields, who guide and inspire groundbreaking research. Supporting this work are over 200 graduate students, blending rigorous academic expertise with bold, creative thinking, and 150 dedicated staff members who provide vital support in administration, design, and operations to turn ideas into reality.

The Lab also benefits from the perspectives of over 50 affiliate and visiting researchers from around the globe, as well as over 400 undergraduate students engaged in hands-on research opportunities that nurture the next generation of innovators. Collaborating with the Lab, 30+ member organizations and philanthropic donors contribute invaluable resources and insights, helping to translate ideas into real-world impact.

Together, this dynamic community combines intellect, imagination, and passion to shape technologies and systems that truly make a difference. It's not just a network – it's a movement, united by a shared belief in creating a better, more just future.

Values

Shared values: Guiding every interaction

Our values define how we work and what we stand for



Working with excellence, integrity, and humility

In our work and our interactions with others, we bring honesty, transparency, respect, and self-accountability.



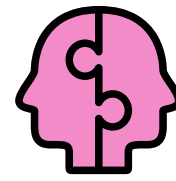
Celebrating individuality and community

We belong to a magical, quirky community, welcoming to and caring for all forms and intersections of diversity, including cultural backgrounds and personal identifications, thought, cross-generational experience, and field of research.



Fostering and developing creativity

We imagine, build, and inspire whole new ways to use imagination and original ideas in our work and research, the ways we think and act, the people and communities we impact, and risk-taking and pushing perceived boundaries in research and innovation.



Collaborating openly and actively

We seek to build new research and working relationships with non-traditional collaborators within the Media Lab, across MIT, and globally from academia, industry, governments, and NGOs, foundations, and other non-profit organizations.



mitmedialab.info/flourish

